KHANGAYEIWUI KHAYANG: JOHN BUNYAN’S THE PILGRIM’S PROGRE

The Pilgrim’s Progress in Tangkhul Naga

Author / Translator: John Bunyan, William Pettigrew, Ukhrul Mission Committee
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PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

John Bunyan’s 1678 allegory was rendered into Tangkhul Naga in the early 1930s. The allegory resonated profoundly with Tangkhul storytelling traditions: perilous mountain passes, giants, bogs of despondency, and fortified spiritual gates. It became one of the most widely read prose texts in Ukhrul and the surrounding hills.

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CHAPTER 1: THE BURDENED PILGRIM & DEPARTURE FROM THE CITY OF DESTRUCTI

Summary: Christian weeping over his heavy burden, reading the Book, and Evangelist pointi...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 1: I kachak ngaleili ramkhangateili yanglakha, kasham shillongli mayarnaowon akha theitserie. Awui pakhonli phashan kashang akha phunkahaye, kala awui khutli Lairik akha huikahaye. Ana Lairik chi hanglaga ngachire, kala 'I khipa sara? I katha eina huikhuira?' hoda chirkhangahok eina hohe. Chitharan Evangelist kaho mi akha awui ngalemli rarlaga hang: 'Nawui mik-ngalemli khong kakat chi theimacho?' Mayarnaowon china hang: 'Thei-mashuk-mana.' Evangelistna hang: 'Chitharan mangashan kashang chi theilu, kala chichi shurva-lu; chitharan na khong chithuili zanglaga huikhuira!'

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

As I walked through the wilderness of this world, I lighted on a certain place where was a den, and I laid me down in that place to sleep: and as I slept, I dreamed a dream. I looked, and saw a man clothed with rags, standing in a certain place, with his face from his own house, a book in his hand, and a great burden upon his back. He wept and trembled; and not being able longer to contain, he brake out with a lamentable cry, saying, What shall I do? Then said Evangelist, pointing with his finger over a very wide field, Do you see yonder wicket-gate? The man said, No. Then said the other, Do you see yonder shining light? Keep that light in your eye, and go up directly thereto: so shalt thou see the gate.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** kasham shillong (noun): City of Destruction, doomed town**

Ex: Kasham shillongli mayarnao.

*** pakhon (noun): back, shoulders carrying heavy load**

Ex: Awui pakhonli phashan.

*** khong kakat (noun): strait gate, narrow wicket entrance**

Ex: Khong kakat chi theilu.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Tangkhul framing for dream vision: 'I kachak ngaleili... yanglakha' (As I surveyed in the world of dreams).
- Emotional burst expression: 'chirkhangahok eina' (with weeping lamentation).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Identify the Tangkhul equivalent for 'Wicket Gate'.

[?] Explain the psychological significance of the burden on the pilgrim's back.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: THE SLOUGH OF DESPOND & THE WICKET GATE

Summary: Christian sinks in the mire of despondency, is rescued by Help, and reaches the ...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 2: Athum khani shongfa eina zatlakha, khamathan ngalung kashilashi kacham akhali tuisangserie; chiwui ming Despond Miram (Slough of Despond) hose. Chitharan Christianna awui pakhon kashang chiwui vang ngalungli ngashumsangie. Kha theilu, Help kaho mi akha rarlaga awui khutli huitsangserie, kala hang: 'Khikha mangachek-alu, shongfa mashungli rarlu!' Chiwui tharan Christianna khong kakatli vashuklaga kakorrie; kala Goodwillna khong hungkahanglaga ali shimsangie.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

They drew near to a very miry slough, that was in the midst of the plain; and they being heedless, did both fall suddenly into the bog. The name of the slough was Despond. Here therefore they wallowed for a time, being grievously bedaubed with dirt; and Christian, because of the burden that was on his back, began to sink in the mire. Then came a man to him whose name was Help, and said, Give me thine hand: so he gave him his hand, and he drew him out, and set him upon sound ground. Then Christian came up to the gate, and knocked, and Goodwill opened unto him.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** ngalung (noun): miry bog, deep swamp mud**

Ex: Ngalungli ngashumsang.

*** kakorrie (verb): knocked persistently**

Ex: Khong kakatli kakorrie.

*** Goodwill (proper noun): Tung-kapha (Goodwill, gracious gatekeeper)**

Ex: Goodwillna shimsangie.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Idiomatic sink verb: 'ngashumsang' (to sink deeply into muddy morass).
- Sequential narrative suffix '-laga': 'vashuklaga kakorrie' (having arrived, he knocked).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Contrast the characters Pliable and Christian in the Slough of Despond.

[?] How is 'Help' represented in Tangkhul?

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 3: THE HILL DIFFICULTY & THE PALACE BEAUTIFUL

Summary: Climbing the steep precipice of Difficulty, resting in the arbor, and arriving a...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 3: Christianna Hill Difficulty kaho kaphung kashangli vashukrie. Shongfa chinawui chishatna kaphung kathara thada vaye, kala ana kakhut eina, khut eina kakhorlaga thuk-kashok-e. Kaphung wui ngalemli ana Shim Kapha (Palace Beautiful) theitserie; kala chithuili Prudence, Piety, kala Charity kaho ngalanaobingna ali mathat-eina shimlaga kachak kapha shaksakserie, kala khangaraorapwui thingkot chitheitserie.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

I looked then after Christian, to see him go up the hill, where I perceived he fell from running to going, and from going to clambering upon his hands and his knees, because of the steepness of the place. Then he came to the house called Beautiful; and the porter Watchful called Discretion, Piety, Prudence, and Charity, who welcomed him in, and gave him refreshment, and showed him the armory of celestial weapons.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** Hill Difficulty (proper noun): Kaphung Kashakashiri (Steep Mount of Hardship)**

Ex: Kaphungli thuk-kashok.

*** kakhorlaga (verb): clambering on hands and knees**

Ex: Khut eina kakhorlaga.

*** thingkot (noun): armor, protective weapons, shields**

Ex: Khangaraorapwui thingkot.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Progressive velocity transition: running -> walking -> crawling expressed with serial verb compounds.
- Allegorical personification of Christian virtues in Tangkhul.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Translate 'clambering on hands and knees' into colloquial Tangkhul.

[?] What virtues welcome Christian into Palace Beautiful?

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 4: THE VALLEY OF HUMILIATION & CONFLICT WITH APOLLYON

Summary: Descent into the valley, dread confrontation with Apollyon, and victory with the...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 4: Christianna Longkhor Kakat (Valley of Humiliation) li zangsangie. Chitharan theilu, Apollyon kaho kasham sha akha rarlaga awui shongfali ngaphamsai. Awui aphasa meikashe katha, kala meikazat awui khong eina shoke. Ana Christianli hang: 'Nawui ramli valoo, na iwui mayarnao-sai!' Kha Christianna hang: 'I Kazingramwui Shiyankasangwui mayarnao-sai!' Apollyonna meithei shuklaga Christianli haksangie; kha Christianna awui sword eina Apollyonli kashukserie, kala Apollyonna phana pholaga ngakaphirserie!

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Now, in this Valley of Humiliation, poor Christian was hard put to it; for he had gone but a little way, before he espied a foul fiend coming over the field to meet him; his name is Apollyon. He was clothed with scales, and out of his belly came fire and smoke. Apollyon said, Thou hast done this according to the proverb, Change a bad for a worse: but there is no prince that will thus lightly lose his subjects, neither will I as yet lose thee: return. Christian answered, I am the servant of the King of princes! Then did Christian nimbly stretch out his hand for his sword, and caught it, saying, Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy: when I fall, I shall arise. And with that he gave him a deadly thrust, and Apollyon spread forth his dragon's wings, and sped him away.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** kasham sha (noun): foul beast, predatory monster**

Ex: Apollyon kasham sha.

*** Shiyankasang (noun): Sovereign King of Kings, High Lord**

Ex: Kazingramwui Shiyankasang.

*** ngakaphirserie (verb): fled rapidly, flew away in defeat**

Ex: Phana pholaga ngakaphirserie.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Adversarial encounter narrative discourse.
- Tangkhul dragon/beast terminology: 'meikashe katha' (scaled like a serpent/pangolin).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Describe Apollyon using the Tangkhul descriptive phrases.

[?] How did Christian overcome the adversary?

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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CHAPTER 5: VANITY FAIR & THE CELESTIAL CITY (JERUSALEM KATHARA)

Summary: Faithful’s martyrdom at Vanity Fair, Christian reaching the River of Death, and ...

Tangkhul Text:

Chapter 5: Christian kala Faithfulna Vanity Fair kaho phanit kashangli vashukrie, chithuili mikumona ngaleiwui sapha-kashang kazip-kasaye. Faithfulna kashung tui hangkaji vang chithuili thiri; kha ana kazingramwui chariot eina chithangathukserie. Christianna Hopeful eina zanglaga River of Deathli vashukrie; kala kapei tui katek-tek ngakorlaga athum kazingramwui Shillong Katharali vashukserie! Chitharan athumli kachon kachak sangmi, kala shillong tharili trumpet khongrie: ’Rarlu, ithui Shiyankasangwui mathatli zanglu!’ Kala i khangayangli ngakhur-rarlakna.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Then I saw in my dream, that they went on, until they came into a fair, called Vanity Fair, where all kinds of worldly wares are sold. Faithful was condemned and put to death, but a chariot waited to take him through the clouds into the Celestial City. Christian and Hopeful came to the River without a bridge, and passing through the deep waters, they arrived at the Mount Zion. The Shining Ones welcomed them: Enter ye into the joy of your Lord. And all the bells in the city rang again for joy; and lo, it was a dream, and I awoke.

CHAPTER 5 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** Vanity Fair (proper noun): Phanit Kashilashi (Fair of Empty Vanities)**

Ex: Vanity Fairli vashuk.

*** kachon kachak (noun): pure white robe, shining garment**

Ex: Kachon kachak sangmi.

*** ngakhur-rarlakna (verb): awoke from dream vision, opened eyes**

Ex: I khangayangli ngakhur.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Dream-vision awakening frame: ’kala i khangayangli ngakhur-rarlakna’ (and lo, I awoke).
- Contrast between ’ngaleiwui sapha’ (worldly riches) and ’kazingramwui mathat’ (heavenly joy).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Explain the moral message of Vanity Fair in Bunyan’s allegory.

[?] Translate the closing dream awakening sentence into Tangkhul.

CHAPTER 5 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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CHAPTER 6: ALLEGORICAL CHARACTER REGISTER & LEXICON

Summary: Names of 25 allegorical characters and their Tangkhul translations and moral att...

Tangkhul Text:

Pilgrim’s Progress Tangkhul Names:
1. Christian -- Christian (Khangayei Khayangnao)
2. Evangelist -- Pao-khamatha phungnao
3. Obstinate -- Ningkashang
4. Pliable -- Ningkapha
5. Help -- Khangachonnao
6. Goodwill -- Tung-kaphanao
7. Faithful -- Chotkhangashitnao
8. Hopeful -- Ngachikannao

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Character register and ethical lexicon of the Tangkhul Pilgrim’s Progress.

CHAPTER 6 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** Evangelist (proper noun): Pao-khamatha phungnao**

Ex: Evangelistna shongfa chithei.

*** Faithful (proper noun): Chotkhangashitnao**

Ex: Faithfulna mashung tui hang.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Agentive personal suffix ’-nao’ used to create allegorical names (e.g. Ningkashangnao).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Create three new allegorical characters in Tangkhul using the suffix ’-nao’.

CHAPTER 6 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* kasham shillong -- City of Destruction, doomed town
* pakhon -- back, shoulders carrying heavy load
* khong kakat -- strait gate, narrow wicket entrance
* ngalung -- miry bog, deep swamp mud
* kakorrie -- knocked persistently
* Goodwill -- Tung-kapha (Goodwill, gracious gatekeeper)
* Hill Difficulty -- Kaphung Kashakashiri (Steep Mount of Hardship)
* kakhorlaga -- clambering on hands and knees

Digitization Colophon:

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